

Tasin Academy

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The following speech is a selection from Nelson Mandela's statement at a trial in 1964. He had been arrested by South African security police in 1962 for his opposition to the white government and policy of racial, economic, and political separatism that is called 'apartheid'. In 1964, further charges were brought against Mandela, including sabotage, high treason, and conspiracy to overthrow the government.

"I am the First Accused.

I hold a Bachelor's Degree in Arts and practiced as an attorney in Johannesburg for a number of years in partnership with Oliver Tambo. I am a convicted prisoner serving five years for leaving the country without a permit and for inciting people to go on strike at the end of May 1961.

At the outset, I want to say that the suggestion made by the State in its opening that the struggle in South Africa is under the influence of foreigners or communists is wholly incorrect. I have done whatever I did, both as an individual and as a leader of my people, because of my experience in South Africa and my own proudly felt African background, and not because of what any outsider might have said.

In my youth in the Transkei I listened to the elders of my tribe telling stories of the old days. Amongst the names of Dingane and Bambata, Hintsa and Makana, Squintghi and Dalasile, Moshoeshe and Sekhukhuni, were praised as the glory of the entire African nation. I hoped then that life might offer me the opportunity to serve my people and make my own humble contribution to their freedom struggle. This is what has motivated me in all that I have done in relation to the charges made against me in this case."

1.A. Choose the correct answer from the alternatives:

(10x0.5=5)

(a) What does the word 'accused' refer to in the context of the passage?

- (i) A person who defends someone (ii) A person who witnesses a crime
(iii) A person charged with a crime (iv) A person who judges a crime

(b) What was Nelson Mandela convicted of?

- (i) The act of revolution (ii) The involvement in cybercrime
(iii) The act of treachery (iv) The act of murder

(c) What does the word 'permit' mean in the context of the passage?

- (i) A request (ii) A written accusation (iii) An oral permission
(iv) A legal document allowing entry or exit

(d) Which of the following statements is NOT false?

- (i) The struggle in South Africa was against apartheid.
(ii) The struggle in South Africa was under the influence of the communists.
(iii) The struggle in South Africa was under the influence of foreigners.
(iv) The struggle in South Africa was against the negroes.

(e) What does the word 'inciting' substitute for in the context of the passage?

- (i) Encouraging unlawful activity (ii) Preventing a dispute
(iii) Observing a conflict (iv) Supporting a lawful cause

(f) Who is the author of the statement, 'I am the First Accused'?

- (i) Nelson Mandela (ii) Oliver Tambo (iii) Bambata (iv) Dingane

(g) What degree does Nelson Mandela hold?

- (i) Master's Degree (ii) Bachelor's Degree in Arts
(iii) Bachelor's Degree in Science (iv) Doctorate in Law

(h) What does 'communists' mean?

- (i) A group of social workers (ii) A group of religious workers
(iii) A party of political activists (iv) A group of rights activists

(i) Who was Nelson Mandela's partner in his legal practice?

- (i) Dingane (ii) Bambata (iii) Oliver Tambo (iv) Hintsa

(j) How long is Nelson Mandela serving for his convictions?

- (i) Three years (ii) Five years (iii) Seven years (iv) Ten years

1.B. Answer the following questions:

(5x2=10)

- (a) What did Mandela hope for in his youth?
(b) What does Mandela mean by "my own proudly felt African background"?
(c) What was the significance of the stories told by elders in Mandela's early life?
(d) How does Mandela perceive the role of leadership in the struggle for freedom?
(e) What does Mandela suggest about personal motivation in activism?

2. Read the passage and complete the table below with the given information. 1x10=10

What/Who	Event/Activity	Where/Place	When/How
Nelson Mandela	(i).....	Johannesburg	
(ii).....	Incited people to go on strike		(iii).....
(iv).....	Has done whatever he did	South Africa	(v).....
(vi).....	Listened to the elders of his tribe telling stories	(vii).....	(viii).....
The names of Dingane and others	(ix).....		(x).....

Or,

Read the above passage and make a flowchart showing the speaker's statement at a trial in 1964 (One is done for you.)

2x5=10

1. Provides students with personalized learning experiences	→	2	→	3	→	4	→	5	→	6
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3. Summary Writing

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Write a summary of the passage in your own words.